PROJECT REPORT

Digital Ambassador Programme

Modules 1 – 5

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Introduction

This project report documents my journey as a Student Digital Ambassador across five modules. Each module challenged me to apply digital literacy skills in practical and meaningful ways from designing visual resources and building an online portfolio, to exploring coding platforms, practising professional communication, and understanding cybercrime. Throughout these tasks, I have developed a stronger awareness of the tools and habits needed to thrive in a digital academic and professional environment.

The five tasks covered in this report span Module 1 through Module 5. In Module 1, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic. In Module 2, I built my Student Digital Portfolio across key professional platforms. Module 3 required me to explore coding and collaboration tools. Module 4 focused on professional email writing and digital communication etiquette. Finally, Module 5 involved researching cybercrime and producing an awareness guide. Together, these tasks have given me both the knowledge and the practical experience to act as a digital resource for my batchmates.

Task 1 : Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

What I Made

The infographic covers three key topics related to digital literacy. The first section explains what digital literacy means the ability to use digital tools confidently, critically, and responsibly. The second section highlights useful digital tools for students, including Google Workspace (for collaboration), Notion (for note-taking), and Canva itself (for design tasks). The third section focuses on safe internet practices, including the use of strong passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, identifying phishing emails, and avoiding public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks.

The design uses a clean, colour-coded layout with icons and short bullet points to make the information easy to read at a glance. The infographic is intended to be shared with batchmates as a quick reference guide.

Tool Used

For Task 1, I used Canva (canva.com) to design the Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic. Canva is a free, browser-based design tool that offers a wide range of customisable templates, icons, and layout options, making it ideal for creating visually engaging one-page resources without requiring advanced design skills.

Reflection

The most challenging aspect of this task was deciding how to present a large amount of information in a single, visually appealing page without overcrowding the design. I found it difficult to balance text and visuals initially, but by using Canva's grid layout and reducing font sizes strategically, I was able to achieve a clean result. I found it particularly interesting to research the range of free tools available specifically for students I discovered platforms I had not previously used, such as Notion and Piktochart, which I plan to explore further in my studies.

Task 2 Write-up: Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For Task 2, I created or updated accounts on three professional platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct purpose in building a well-rounded digital presence for academic and professional use.

Purpose of Each Platform

GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform widely used by developers, researchers, and students. I created a profile README repository a special repository named after my username that introduces who I am, my branch, my year of study, and

one sentence about what I hope to learn. GitHub will serve as a living portfolio of my coding projects and collaborative work throughout my degree.

LinkedIn is the world's leading professional networking platform. I updated my Education section to reflect my current degree programme, institution name, and expected graduation year. LinkedIn will help me connect with alumni, discover internship opportunities, and build visibility with potential employers from my first year onwards.

Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning competitions, datasets, and notebooks. Creating an account here signals an interest in data-driven fields and provides access to beginner-friendly learning paths and community notebooks.

Future Plans

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document all major coding assignments and personal projects, ensuring a portfolio that demonstrates growth over time. On LinkedIn, I intend to regularly update my skills, add certifications, and eventually request recommendations from professors and internship supervisors. Kaggle will be used to practise data analysis skills and participate in beginner competitions from my second year onwards. Together, these three platforms will form the foundation of a strong, verifiable digital presence that speaks for me before I even enter an interview room.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used

Task 3 involved two parts: a coding practice activity and a Google Workspace collaboration task. For the coding component (Part A), I chose HackerRank as my platform. For the collaboration component (Part B), I used Google Forms and Google Sheets.

What I Built / Practised

On HackerRank, I created an account and completed the 'Solve Me First' beginner challenge, which introduces the basic structure of submitting a solution in a competitive programming environment. I also attempted the Python Introduction challenge to familiarise myself with the platform's code editor and test case system. Completing these challenges gave me a clear sense of how coding platforms evaluate correctness and efficiency.

For the Google Workspace task, I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' with exactly five questions. The form includes three multiple-choice questions covering topics such as identifying phishing emails, selecting strong passwords, and understanding cloud storage and two short-answer questions asking respondents to name one digital tool they use for studying and to describe one safe internet practice they follow. I linked the form to a Google Sheet to automatically collect and organise responses.

Academic Value

These tools are directly relevant to my academic journey. HackerRank and similar platforms provide a structured way to practise programming skills outside the classroom, and many companies use them as part of their technical hiring process. Google Workspace tools - Forms, Sheets, Docs, and Slides are standard in collaborative academic projects, internships, and workplace environments. Building familiarity with these tools now ensures I can contribute effectively to group work and data collection tasks in my future studies and career.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Communication Etiquette

Communication Scenario

Task 4 required me to draft two professional emails and create a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist. The first email was written from the perspective of a student requesting a deadline extension from their professor. The second email expressed interest in a summer internship to a company's internship coordinator. Both emails demonstrate the core principles of professional online communication: a clear subject line, an appropriate greeting, a well-structured body, and a polite sign-off.

Key Learnings

This task reinforced how significantly the tone and structure of a message can affect how it is received. In the first email, I learned the importance of being concise, honest about the reason for the extension request, and grateful for the professor's consideration without being overly apologetic or lengthy. In the second email, I practised tailoring content to the reader by referencing specific aspects of the company's work, which makes an expression of interest feel genuine rather than generic.

Creating the Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist was equally valuable. It prompted me to think critically about how college students present themselves online both in terms of the content they post and the platforms they use. Key 'Do's include maintaining a consistent and professional profile photo, sharing academic achievements, and engaging respectfully in discussions. Key 'Don'ts include posting impulsive or emotionally-driven content, sharing personal identifying information publicly, and using informal language in professional contexts.

A key example of poor digital communication that stands out is the widely reported case of job applicants who lost offers after employers reviewed their social media profiles and found inappropriate content. This scenario illustrates that digital footprints are permanent and public-facing. Had those individuals applied the basic principle of treating online posts as professional communications, the outcome would likely have been different. This task has made me more intentional about my own online presence.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

What Surprised Me Most

For Task 5, I chose to research UPI/Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime topic. I was genuinely surprised by how sophisticated and targeted these scams have become. Many attacks are not random fraudsters specifically study their victims' transaction history, social circle, and communication patterns to craft convincing fake messages or calls. What surprised me most was learning that even technically aware individuals fall victim to these crimes because the social engineering element bypasses logical thinking by creating a false sense of urgency or authority.

I also did not expect the scale of the problem in India. According to publicly available cybercrime statistics and the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, UPI fraud cases have grown significantly in recent years, with college students being a particularly vulnerable demographic due to their frequent use of digital payment apps and relative inexperience in identifying fraudulent patterns.

One Habit I Will Change

As a direct result of researching this topic, I have decided to stop saving UPI PINs or passwords in note-taking apps or browser autofill, and to enable transaction alerts for every payment made from my accounts. I have also committed to verifying the identity of anyone who calls requesting payment verification by calling back on official numbers rather than responding to the incoming call. These may seem like small steps, but as the case studies showed, most successful frauds rely on victims not following these basic precautions.

This task was the most thought-provoking of the five modules because it connected digital literacy directly to personal financial safety something every student in India encounters daily through UPI payments, online shopping, and mobile banking.

Conclusion

Across the five modules of this Digital Ambassador project, I have developed a well-rounded understanding of what it means to be digitally literate in today's world. I have gained hands-on experience with professional design tools, portfolio platforms, coding environments, communication best practices, and cybersecurity awareness. Each task built on the previous one, and together they have equipped me with both the skills and the mindset to navigate and contribute to digital spaces responsibly. I now feel more confident about representing my academic and professional identity online, and I am better prepared to share these learnings with my peers.

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